

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Paralegal role in your Residential Property team because my background in disputes-focused legal work has given me direct experience of the document management, client communication and deadline tracking that residential property work depends on, and I want to develop that foundation in a transactional property setting.

During my year at BCLP, six months of which were spent in Real Estate Disputes, I supported hearing preparation across several leasehold, landlord and tenant, and rights of light matters. That meant reviewing documents, preparing electronic bundles, drafting client notes and maintaining matter records on iManage, often across competing deadlines. Working in a disputes context meant understanding the substantive property issues behind each matter, not just the procedural steps, which has given me a grounding in residential property concepts that I expect to be useful in a transactional role. At Citizens Advice, where I have been advising clients since July 2026, I manage housing and benefits matters from first instruction through to submission. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence, and translate complex statutory rules into practical guidance for clients who are often in difficult situations. Working with individuals across a wide range of housing circumstances, including those unfamiliar with legal processes, has sharpened my ability to communicate clearly and keep matters on track without losing sight of the client's position.

I am drawn to this role because working alongside experienced property solicitors on a varied caseload, from first-time buyers to investors, is a natural next step after two years of handling legally complex matters in environments where accuracy and organisation directly affected outcomes. The Marlow location also suits me practically, as I am based in Maidenhead.

I am ready to contribute from the start and to build the property-specific transactional knowledge that this role offers.

Yours sincerely,

Maria Silva